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World Cup Fantasy 2026 tips: The Ultimate Guide to the Round of 32

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Looking for the best World Cup Fantasy 2026 tips? We've got everything you need to know about the official FIFA game.

This Ultimate Guide brings together all our [award-winning](#) tips, including expert insight from some of your favourite content creators.

Beat your rivals and win your mini-leagues by bookmarking this page – updated throughout the tournament.

Last updated: 28/06/26

World Cup Fantasy 2026: The key info and dates

We've reached the knockout stage, with the Round of 32 beginning on Sunday (June 28).

The graphic below outlines the route to the final for all teams.

- 📅 **Round of 32 deadline:** 20:00 UK time, Sunday, June 28
- 🏆 **World Cup final:** Sunday, July 19



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World Cup knockout draw

World Cup Fantasy Round of 32 fixtures: Teams to target

World Cup Fantasy managers will be keenly looking at the Round of 32 fixtures – but will also have one eye on their path through the knockout stages.

If you’ve not got a Wildcard in hand, you’ll only have free transfers to swap out eliminated players. Everyone will get four free transfers ahead of the Round of 16, while we now have unlimited moves up to the Round of 32 deadline.

The overall budget has increased from \$100m to \$105m too, making it easier to fit in more premium picks.

Round of 32 projections

Here’s how the market odds collated by [FPL Joe](#) rank the best teams for the Round of 32.

With tighter ties and knockout football, the goal projections are lower than many group games:

- 🏆 **Target for goals:** Argentina (2.67), France (2.49), England (2.22), Spain (2.18), Germany (2.17)
- 🧤 **Target for clean sheets:** Argentina (67%), Spain (62%), England (59%), Colombia (52%), USA (51%), Germany (50%)

And for those playing the Qualification Booster, [Opta](#) rates these sides as having the best chance of progressing to the Round of 16:



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- **England:** 84.04%
- **France:** 81.46%
- **Germany:** 78.58%



| Lionel Messi. Picture by Getty Images

Knockout stage projections

Looking further ahead, here’s who Opta rank as having the best chance of making the final:

- **Argentina:** 30.04%
- **France:** 28.37%
- **Spain:** 22.66%
- **England:** 18.63%
- **Brazil:** 13.68%



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Monday 29 June 2026		
Brazil	18:00	Japan
Germany	21:30	Paraguay
Tuesday 30 June 2026		
Netherlands	02:00	Morocco
Côte d'Ivoire	18:00	Norway
France	22:00	Sweden
Wednesday 1 July 2026		
Mexico	02:00	Ecuador
England	17:00	Congo DR
Belgium	21:00	Senegal
Thursday 2 July 2026		
USA	01:00	Bosnia and Herzegovina
Spain	20:00	Austria
Friday 3 July 2026		
Portugal	00:00	Croatia
Switzerland	04:00	Algeria
Australia	18:00	Egypt
Argentina	23:00	Cabo Verde
Saturday 4 July 2026		
Colombia	02:30	Ghana

World Cup Fantasy fixture timings (UK)

World Cup Fantasy 2026 expert team reveals

Want to know how some of the best fantasy minds in the business are playing this year’s game?

Elite managers BigManBakar and FPL Salah reveal their plans for Hub members to view:

- [NEW: BigManBakar’s World Cup Fantasy 2026 team reveal for the Round of 32](#)
- [NEW: FPL Salah’s World Cup Fantasy 2026 team reveal for the Round of 32](#)
- [NEW: Fantasy Football Hub’s World Cup Fantasy 2026 team reveal for the Round of 32](#)

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Florian Wirtz. Picture by Getty Images

Best World Cup Fantasy 2026 players and differentials: Round of 32

- 🏆 **Selected top picks:** Lionel Messi, Kylian Mbappe, Vinicius Junior
- 🥈 **Selected differentials:** Johan Manzambi, Nahuel Molina, Douglas Santos, Folarin Balogun

Elite FPL manager and modeller [Elevenify](#) has released his player projections for the Round of 32, with Messi leading the way for goal involvements.

The data assumes a start, so some players – like **Julian Alvarez** – may not realise their full potential.



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K. Mbappe		0.73	0.33	1.06
L. Martinez		0.75	0.29	1.04
J. Alvarez		0.71	0.26	0.97
F. Balogun		0.59	0.32	0.91
Vinicius Junior		0.53	0.37	0.90
C. Pulisic		0.53	0.36	0.89
G. Simeone		0.51	0.35	0.86
K. Havertz		0.57	0.25	0.82
T. Almada		0.45	0.37	0.82
D. Undav		0.63	0.18	0.81
R. Pepi		0.58	0.22	0.80
M. Olise		0.36	0.44	0.80
N. Woltemade		0.56	0.22	0.78
M. Thuram		0.49	0.28	0.77
J. David		0.44	0.31	0.75

Elevenify Round of 32 player projections

World Cup Fantasy 2026 booster strategy

It'll be a choice of the Qualification Booster or the Clean Sheet Shield for many managers at this stage of the competition – with the former perhaps the most popular.

See our chip strategy guide for full details and tips:

- [READ MORE: World Cup Fantasy 2026 Chip Strategy Guide](#)



Colombia players. Picture by Getty Images



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